RE: [EXT] - Re: FOI2025-059 – Scope Clarification Response

OFFICIAL

Good afternoon Hanyu

Thank you for your response and for amending the scope of your application to the following:

1.1 Relevant Recordkeeping Plan schedules/disposal authorities for animal welfare inspector appointments, training, and enforcement actions.

1.2 Any risk assessments or audits regarding DI/GI recordkeeping compliance (Section 26 if none).

1.3 FOI search documentation for FOI2025-008, -017, and -049 (custodians, systems, dates).

2.1 DI/GI appointment template and register/database of appointments (Section 26 if none).

2.2 Mandatory training modules or competency standards for DI/GI appointments (Section 26 if none).

3.1 Chart-of-accounts or cost centre codes used for DI/GI operations, FY2022–25 (metadata only).

3.2 Budget submissions or internal financial reports referencing DI/GI allocations, FY2022–25 (if readily available).

Thank you for acknowledging that an extension of time to process your application may be necessary and advising that you do not object to a reasonable extension once the scope of your application has been confirmed.

Thank you

Kind Regards

Courtney Taylor | A/Privacy and Information Access Coordinator
Enterprise Information Management
Department of Primary Industries and Regional Development
Level 12, 140 William Street, Perth WA 6000
t (08) 6551 4410 | **w** dpird.wa.gov.au
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	Mon	Tue	Wed	Thur	Fri
Work Location	Office	Office	Home	Office	Office
			Pay Week		
	Office	Office	Home	Office	Office
			Non-Pay Week		

From: Hanyu Liu <helloluna520@gmail.com>
Sent: Friday, 31 October 2025 7:39 PM
To: FOI <FOI@dpird.wa.gov.au>
Subject: [EXT] - Re: FOI2025-059 – Scope Clarification Response

CAUTION: This email originated from outside of DPIRD. Do not click links or open attachments unless you recognise the sender and know the content is safe.

Dear Ms Taylor,

Thank you for your correspondence dated 31 October 2025.

Re: Scope Clarification

My application remains specific to the *Designated Inspector (DI)* program, as defined under section 35A of the *Animal Welfare Act 2002 (WA).*

I acknowledge that DIs are appointed from the General Inspector cohort; therefore, where no DI-specific documents exist as a separate category, this request extends to any documents relating to or including DIs within the broader General Inspector framework, limited strictly to the operational functions listed in my application (appointments, training, budget, recordkeeping).

This does not constitute a request for "all DPIRD staff" records or unrelated General Inspector documentation.

Re: Preliminary Section 20 Assessment

I respectfully submit that DPIRD's preliminary assessment overstates the potential workload. Each category requested is discrete and readily identifiable:

1. **Recordkeeping Plan (Part 1.1)** – Only the specific RKP schedules/disposal authorities governing DI/GI appointment, training, and enforcement records (estimated 5–10 pages), not the full 230-page plan.
2. **Appointment Documentation (Part 2.1)** – This is a binary matter: either an appointment register or template exists, or it does not (Section 26 may apply).
3. **Budget Metadata (Part 3.1)** – Chart-of-accounts codes and cost centres are standard under the *Financial Management Act 2006* and should be readily identifiable.
4. **FOI Search Logs (Part 1.3)** – In accordance with OIC's *Reasonable Search Guidelines*, agencies typically document systems searched and custodians contacted. These records should already exist, or else can be addressed under Section 26.

The request therefore targets narrow, pre-existing document classes and should not meet the threshold for refusal under Section 20.

Refined Scope for Processing

To assist DPIRD in proceeding efficiently, I confirm the following refined and manageable scope:

1.1 Relevant Recordkeeping Plan schedules/disposal authorities for animal welfare inspector appointments, training, and enforcement actions.

1.2 Any risk assessments or audits regarding DI/GI recordkeeping compliance (Section 26 if none).

1.3 FOI search documentation for FOI2025-008, -017, and -049 (custodians, systems, dates).
2.1 DI/GI appointment template and register/database of appointments (Section 26 if none).

2.2 Mandatory training modules or competency standards for DI/GI appointments (Section 26 if none).

3.1 Chart-of-accounts or cost centre codes used for DI/GI operations, FY2022–25 (metadata only).

3.2 Budget submissions or internal financial reports referencing DI/GI allocations, FY2022–25 (if readily available).

This refined scope seeks:

- identifiable sections of existing documents;
- metadata rather than full datasets; and
- yes/no confirmation of existence (with Section 26 where applicable).

Re: Meeting Offer

I appreciate the offer to meet with Mr Chambers but prefer to maintain transparency through written correspondence under the *Freedom of Information Act 1992 (WA).*

Re: Extension of Time

I acknowledge that an extension may be necessary and do not object to a reasonable extension (up to 30 days) once the scope is confirmed.

I trust this clarification sufficiently narrows the request to allow processing without substantial diversion.

Please proceed with processing the refined scope outlined above.

Kind regards,

Hanyu Liu

helloluna520@gmail.com

On Fri, 31 Oct 2025 at 12:34 pm, FOI <FOI@dpird.wa.gov.au> wrote:

OFFICIAL

Good Afternoon Hanyu
I refer to your access application request under the *Freedom of Information 1992* (WA)(FOI Act) (FOI reference FOI2025-059) made to the Department of Primary Industries and Regional Development (DPIRD).
You have requested the following;

"1. Compliance with the State Records Act 2000
Please provide documents demonstrating DPIRD's compliance with the State Records Act 2000 (WA) in relation to the: "Designated Inspector (DI)" program, including:
1.1 The current, approved Recordkeeping Plan (RKP) approved by the State Records Commission, and the Retention & Disposal Schedule entries that define the record creating and record-keeping requirements for:
- *DI appointments and revocations*
- *DI training and competency assessments*
- *DI inspections, reports, and enforcement outcomes.*

1.2 Any risk assessments, internal audits, or formal correspondence (internal or external) concerning DPIRD's compliance with the State Records Act 2000 or its approved RKP, in relation to recordkeeping practices for the DI program.
1.3 The FOI processing search logs or "reasonable search" worksheets (e.g. systems queried, custodians contacted, and date-time stamps) used by DPIRD staff when processing my previous FOI applications FOI2025-008, FOI2025-017, and FOI2025-049.
2. Lawful Delegation and Authority of Designated Inspectors
Please provide documents establishing the lawful appointment, delegation, and oversight of Designated Inspectors under the Animal Welfare Act 2002 (WA) and related administrative instruments, including:
2.1 The standard instrument of appointment template (or equivalent) and any register, database, or schedule recording the appointment, renewal, or cessation of Designated Inspectors.
2.2 Any mandatory pre-appointment training modules, assessment criteria, or competency standards that an officer must meet to be appointed or renewed as a Designated Inspector.
3. Financial Accountability and Operational Expenditure
Please provide financial records evidencing the operational and budgetary existence of the "Designated Inspector" function, including:
3.1 The chart-of-accounts codes, cost centre codes, or cost objects used to budget for and record expenditure related to DI operations (including training, equipment, travel, or inspection activities) for the financial years 2022-23, 2023-24, and 2024- 25.
3.2 Any budget submissions, internal financial reports, or expenditure summaries referencing DI-related costs, allocations, or activities within those same financial years." (Application)

Clarification of Scope
In reading the scope of your Application, the access request is specific to documents relating to Designated Inspectors (DIs), which is taken to refer to designated inspector as defined in section 5 and 35A of the *Animal Welfare Act 2002* (AW Act). Under the AW Act, DIs are a subclass General Inspectors appointed by the Director General in accordance with section 35A of that Act.
As advised in previous decisions (FOI2025-08, FOI2025-017 and FOI2025-049), in which the scope of your applications were specific to request documents relating to DIs, DPIRD does not hold documentation specifically relating to DIs which is separate to that for General Inspectors, or DPIRD staff based on the scopes of your previous FOI applications (FOI2025-08, FOI2025-017 and FOI2025-049).
With this in mind, please clarify whether your request is for General Inspectors and NOT all DPIRD staff or specific to DIs only.

Preliminary Search & Reduction of Scope
Please note however that a request for documents relating to General Inspectors and/or all DPIRD staff, as applicable, would likely result in a diversion of a substantial and unreasonable portion of the agency's resources away from its other operations in order to process the application, as a preliminary search identified DPIRD's Record Keeping Plan consisting of 230 pages.

Staff would be required to divert an unreasonable and disproportionate amount of resources to processing the application, by reviewing the large number of pages, and conducting searches for the other points of the scope of your application. Following this a review of the documents would be required to determine if they fall within the scope of your application. This is on top of undertaking any necessary consultations, and drafting a decision as is required under section 30 of the FOI Act.

Section 20 of the FOI Act states that an agency may refuse to deal with an application if they consider the work involved would divert a substantial and unreasonable portion of the agency's resources away from other operations. In accordance with section 20(1) of the FOI Act, the agency must take reasonable steps to help you, as the applicant to narrow the scope of an application to reduce the amount of work required to deal with it.
Accordingly, in light of this, to make your application manageable, I suggest amending the scope of your application to the following, for your consideration:

- *The FOI processing search logs or "reasonable search" worksheets (e.g. systems queried, custodians contacted, and date-time stamps) used by DPIRD staff when processing my previous FOI applications FOI2025-008, FOI2025-017, and FOI2025-049.*
- *The standard instrument of appointment template (or equivalent) and any register, database, or schedule recording the appointment, renewal, or cessation of General Inspectors, including Designated Inspectors.*
- *Any mandatory pre-appointment training modules, assessment criteria, or competency standards that an officer must meet to be appointed or renewed for General Inspectors, including Designated Inspectors.*
- *The chart-of-accounts codes, cost centre codes, or cost objects used to budget for and record expenditure related to General Inspectors, including Designated Inspectors for the financial years 2022-23, 2023-24, and 2024- 25.*
- *Any budget submissions, internal financial reports, or expenditure summaries referencing General Inspectors, including Designated Inspectors for the financial years 2022-23, 2023-24, and 2024-25.*

Please advise if you are agreeable to amending the scope of the application as suggested in the points above. Your suggestions are also welcome.
Once I have received your response, I will review the scope of the application to determine whether it could be processed without a substantial and unreasonable diversion of resources. I may revert to you to attempt to refine the scope further.

Offer of Engagement
To assist to provide you with greater understanding of the legislation relating to, and operations of, General Inspectors, and the power provided which authorises the transition of a General Inspector to Designated Inspector the Director Regional Compliance South has offered to speak or meet with you to provide further information. You are encouraged to contact Noel Chambers – Director Regional Compliance South, on (08) 9892 8492 or noel.chambers@dpird.wa.gov.au.

As previously advised arrangements can be made to ensure a transparent and documented discussion.
I await your advice on how to proceed with the Application. It is anticipated that an extension of time to process your application will be required, I will be able to determine how much additional time will be required when I receive your response to the scope and conduct further searches.
Kind Regards
Courtney Taylor | A/Privacy and Information Access Coordinator
Enterprise Information Management
Department of Primary Industries and Regional Development
Level 12, 140 William Street, Perth WA 6000
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Chat with me on Teams!

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Work Location	Office	Office	Home	Office	Office
			Pay Week		
	Office	Office	Home	Office	Office
			Non-Pay Week		

Department of Primary Industries and Regional Development
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DPIRD acknowledges the Traditional Custodians of Country, the Aboriginal people of the many lands that we work on and their language groups throughout Western Australia and recognise their continuing connection to the land and waters.

We respect their continuing culture and the contribution they make to the life of our regions and we pay our respects to their Elders past, present and emerging.

Artwork: "Kangaroos going to the Waterhole" by Willarra Barker.

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